

Accessible Music Downloader

User Manual — Version 1.8.3 — Developed by Nicolás Alfaro

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1. Introduction

Accessible Music Downloader is a Windows application designed to search, play and download multimedia content with special attention to keyboard navigation and screen readers such as NVDA and JAWS.

This manual describes only user-facing features. Internal components are managed automatically and do not require technical knowledge.

2. Starting the program and portable operation

Open DescargadorMusicaAccesible.exe from the official portable package. You do not need to run additional files or perform external configuration to start using the program.

Do not remove or move the folders and files supplied with the executable.

3. Main interface

The main window contains Download by URL, Search YouTube, and Channels and playlists.

Use Alt+1, Alt+2 and Alt+3 to move between these areas. File, Actions, Search, Tools and Help contain additional features.

4. Download by URL

1. Open Download by URL with Alt+1.
2. Paste the content address.
3. Press Enter and choose the desired action.
4. If you choose Download, select format, quality or resolution when requested.
5. The program announces progress and completion.

5. Search YouTube

Open Search YouTube with Alt+2, enter your query and press Enter.

Results show the index, title, channel, publication date, views and duration when YouTube provides those details. The URL is not shown in the list but remains available internally for playback, download, information and Alt+C copy.

When channel, date or views are missing, the program tries to complete them in the background after you remain on that result. This keeps the initial search fast.

The program can prefer YouTube metadata in the application language. If no translated title is available, the title supplied by YouTube is preserved.

6. Channels and playlists

Open Channels and playlists with Alt+3. Search, choose channel or playlist and open the desired result.

Inside a video list, Space marks or unmarks an item, Enter opens actions, and Ctrl+Shift+D downloads marked videos.

6.1. Favorites

You can save a video to Favorites from YouTube Search results or from the video list of a channel or playlist. With the video focused, press Alt+F. The program will announce “Added to your favorites.” Press Alt+F again on the same video to remove it from Favorites.

You can also press Enter on a video and choose Add to favorites or Remove from favorites from the actions menu.

To view saved items, open Tools, Favorites. The list shows title, channel and type without displaying the URL. In Favorites, Enter opens actions; Alt+D downloads, Alt+R plays, Alt+I shows information, Alt+C copies the URL, and Alt+F or Delete removes the item from Favorites.

Favorites are kept when the program is closed.

6.2. Download queue

You can collect several videos and download them one by one using the Download queue. With a video focused, press Alt+Q or open its actions with Enter and choose Add to download queue. If the item is already queued, the program will report it and will not create a duplicate.

In Channels and playlists you can also mark several videos with Space and press Ctrl+Shift+Q to add them to the queue together.

Open Tools, Download queue to review pending items. The list shows title, channel and status without displaying the URL. You can start the queue, remove an item with Delete, clear the queue, cancel only the current download, or stop the entire queue.

When started, the queue uses the format, quality or resolution, and destination folder currently selected in the main window. Items are downloaded one at a time and the screen reader announces their position, for example: "Downloading 2 of 8."

If you cancel only the current download, that item is removed and the queue continues with the next one. If you stop the queue, pending items are preserved so you can continue later. Items that fail remain in the queue so they can be retried.

The queue is saved when the program closes, but it never starts automatically when the program is opened again.

6.3. Improved playlists

Playlists are managed from the Channels and playlists tab, without adding another tab to the main window.

When the selected result is a playlist, press Enter to open its actions. You can view its contents, add the entire playlist to the download queue, select a range, add or remove the playlist from Favorites, view information, or copy its URL.

If you choose View playlist contents, you can specify how many items to display or choose All. In the resulting list, use Space to select or clear items. When you press Alt+Q, if items are selected, all selected items are added to the queue; if none are selected, only the focused item is added. You can also use Ctrl+Shift+Q to explicitly send selected items to the queue.

Add the entire playlist to the queue loads its items and asks for confirmation before adding them. When the total number is known, the program reports it. Large playlists include a notice that the operation may take some time.

Select a playlist range lets you enter a starting and ending position, for example from 5 through 20. Only those items are loaded and sent to the download queue.

If you paste a playlist URL directly into Download by URL and press Enter or Download, the program detects it and offers the same playlist actions instead of treating it as an individual video.

Playlists can also be saved to Favorites. When you open a saved playlist from Tools, Favorites, you can view its contents, add the entire playlist to the queue, or select a range. The URL is kept internally but is not shown in accessible lists.

7. Internal player

Play lets you listen before downloading.

Main controls: 1 rewind, 2 pause/resume, 3 forward, 4 stop and return, 5 decrease speed, 6 increase speed, 7 decrease volume, 8 increase volume, 9 announce position, 0 announce duration, E turn the experimental equalizer on or off.

The selected volume is preserved and now changes in steps of 2% per keypress for finer control. Choose the audio output device in Tools, Options.

7.1. Experimental equalizer

The E key turns an experimental equalizer on or off inside the internal player. It reproduces the equalization curve the developer configured in Stereo Tool. It is off by default, and the program remembers your choice for the next time you play something.

Being an experimental feature, it may still be adjusted in future versions of the program.

7.2. Playing songs directly from Windows

Besides playing content inside the program, Descargador de Música Accesible can be added to Windows Explorer's Open With menu, to quickly play songs you already have saved on your computer.

To turn it on, open Tools and choose Add "Play with Descargador de Música Accesible" to Windows' menu. The program will confirm once it has been added.

Once added, on any song in MP3, WAV, M4A, FLAC, OGG or WMA format, press the Applications key or right-click and choose Play with Descargador de Música Accesible inside Open With. The song starts playing immediately, without showing the program's main window or the spoken welcome message: only the song's name is announced.

Playback controls are the same as the internal player's, including the experimental equalizer (E key) and the volume control.

If you ever want to remove this option, go back to Tools: the same menu item will now say Remove "Play with Descargador de Música Accesible" from Windows' menu.

Note for Windows 11: in some cases, after adding the option, Windows takes a while to show it in the short Open With flyout that appears on right-click. If you don't see it right away, choose Search for another app on this PC (or Choose another app) inside Open With, or restart your computer.

8. Download formats

Audio: MP3, M4A, AAC, OPUS, OGG, WAV and FLAC.

Video: MP4 at best available resolution or limited to 2160p, 1440p, 1080p, 720p, 480p, 360p, 240p or 144p.

The program handles the required preparation internally.

9. YouTube authentication with cookies.txt

YouTube may occasionally request verification or sign-in. On Windows, the recommended method in Accessible Music Downloader is a cookies.txt file exported from a YouTube session that the user has signed in to.

The file must use Netscape format. The program validates this format before saving the setting. Only the selected file path is stored; its contents are never copied to history, logs, or diagnostic reports.

9.1. Which extension to use, and which browsers work the same way

The recommended extension, Get cookies.txt LOCALLY, works exactly the same in Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Brave, Vivaldi and Opera: it is the same extension, with the same installation link and the same steps inside the extension. Only the name of the install button changes (Add to Chrome, Add to Edge, Add to Brave, etc.), and Edge and Opera each need one extra step before that button appears, covered in their own section below. Mozilla Firefox uses a different, equivalent extension available in its own add-on store.

9.2. Obtain cookies.txt with Google Chrome, Brave or Vivaldi

These three browsers let you install the extension directly, with no extra steps.

1. Open your browser. Press Ctrl+L to move to the address bar.
2. Paste this address and press Enter:
<https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/get-cookiectxt-locally/cclelndahbckbenkjhflpdbgdldlbecc>
3. Find the install button: Add to Chrome, Add to Brave or Add to Vivaldi, depending on your browser. Activate it and, when the browser asks for confirmation, choose Add extension.
4. Open <https://www.youtube.com> and sign in to the account you normally use.
5. Open the browser's Extensions button. With a screen reader, move through the browser toolbar with Tab until you reach Extensions.
6. Choose Get cookies.txt LOCALLY.
7. In the extension, select Netscape format. Do not use JSON.
8. Export the cookies. Your browser will download a file usually named cookies.txt.
9. In Accessible Music Downloader open Tools, Options, YouTube and authentication.
10. Under YouTube authentication method choose cookies.txt file (recommended).
11. Activate Select cookies.txt file, locate the exported file and open it. The program will confirm that it was configured correctly.

Note for Vivaldi: if the Add to Vivaldi button does not appear on the Chrome Web Store page, open Settings, Privacy and security, Google extensions, and enable Web Store; then repeat step 2.

9.3. Obtain cookies.txt with Microsoft Edge

Edge requires enabling extensions from other stores before you can install Get cookies.txt LOCALLY.

1. Open Microsoft Edge and press Ctrl+Shift+X to open Extensions directly.
2. Find and enable Allow extensions from other stores.
3. When Edge shows a warning about unverified extensions, choose Allow.
4. Press Ctrl+L, paste this address and press Enter:
<https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/get-cookies.txt-locally/cclelndahbckbenkjhflpdbgdldlbecc>
5. Activate the Add to Chrome button, which installs the extension the same way in Edge, and confirm with Add extension.
6. Open <https://www.youtube.com> and sign in to the account you normally use.
7. Open the browser's Extensions button, choose Get cookies.txt LOCALLY, select Netscape format and export the file.
8. In Accessible Music Downloader select that file from Tools, Options, YouTube and authentication, following steps 9 through 11 in the Chrome section above.

9.4. Obtain cookies.txt with Opera

Opera first asks you to install its own small companion extension before it will let you install anything else from the Chrome Web Store.

1. Open Opera. Press Ctrl+L, paste this address and press Enter:
<https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/get-cookies.txt-locally/cclelndahbckbenkjhflpdbgdldlbecc>
2. Opera will offer to install Install Chrome Extensions. Activate Install extension and confirm.
3. Return to the Get cookies.txt LOCALLY page, which will now show an Add to Opera button, and activate it.
4. Open <https://www.youtube.com> and sign in to the account you normally use.
5. Open the browser's Extensions button, choose Get cookies.txt LOCALLY, select Netscape format and export the file.

6. In Accessible Music Downloader select that file from Tools, Options, YouTube and authentication, following steps 9 through 11 in the Chrome section above.

9.5. Obtain cookies.txt with Mozilla Firefox

1. Open Firefox and press Ctrl+L.
2. Paste this address and press Enter:
<https://addons.mozilla.org/es-ES/firefox/addon/cookies-txt/>
3. Activate Add to Firefox and confirm the installation.
4. Open <https://www.youtube.com> and sign in.
5. Open Extensions, choose cookies.txt and export the file.
6. Select that file in Accessible Music Downloader from Tools, Options, YouTube and authentication.

9.6. Using another Chromium-based browser?

If your browser is not listed above but is based on Chromium (for example Chromium itself, or a less common one), you can usually install Get cookies.txt LOCALLY by following the same steps as Google Chrome. If the install button does not appear, check that browser's own extension or privacy settings first.

9.7. Direct browser session

Direct browser session remains available as an alternative. In recent Chrome versions on Windows, the system may prevent an external application from decrypting cookies and report a DPAPI error. If that happens, use cookies.txt instead of weakening Windows or browser security.

9.8. Cookie file security

cookies.txt can contain information that permits use of a signed-in session. Do not share it, email it, publish it, or attach it to bug reports. If you believe someone else obtained the file, sign out active sessions and export a new one.

If YouTube requests authentication while a download queue is running, the program pauses the queue and keeps pending items instead of repeating the same error for every item.

10. Tools and options

Tools includes program updates, download-library updates and version information, language selection, and Options.

Options controls update frequency, optional automatic download-library updates, the download-engine channel, result count, YouTube language preference, YouTube authentication method, the cookies.txt file, sounds and player settings.

Stable prioritizes more thoroughly tested releases. Nightly receives recent fixes faster and can be useful when YouTube changes before a new stable release. Master or Development contains the newest changes and is mainly recommended for testing.

If you manually request a library update while already using the latest version, the program reports that no update is available and does not download the same version again.

11. Updates

The program can check for a new application version and offer to download and install it. Manual checking is also available in Tools.

Download-library updates are compared with the installed version before downloading.

12. History

File, View history shows recorded downloads. The history has a record limit to prevent unlimited growth.

File, Clear history removes records without deleting downloaded files.

13. Program size and portable operation

Accessible Music Downloader is designed to provide a complete, stable and simple experience from the first start.

The extracted program may therefore be relatively large. The application includes the tools required for its functions so users do not need to run extra files, install separate components or perform external configuration.

Stability, accessibility and ease of use are prioritized. Thank you for your understanding.

14. Troubleshooting

If a search or download fails, check your Internet connection and try again. If YouTube requests verification, configure a cookies.txt file as described in section 9. If direct browser access reports a DPAPI error, switch to cookies.txt.

If an update check fails, wait a few minutes and try again.

Do not disable Windows Defender or another antivirus as a normal troubleshooting step. Always obtain the program from the official project page.

15. Accessibility

The program is designed for keyboard and screen-reader use. When reporting an accessibility issue, include the program version, screen reader and steps that led to the issue.

Compatible with NVDA and JAWS: the program speaks directly to both screen readers, without relying on additional Windows voices.

16. Contact and support

Developed by Nicolás Alfaro.

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Official project:

<https://github.com/nicoalfaro2026/descargador-musica-accesible>

When reporting a problem, include the program version, screen reader, a short description and steps to reproduce it. Never send passwords or private account data.

17. Responsible use

Use the program only with content you have the right or authorization to download and follow the applicable terms of the source service.